The Sample Company Data

IT Support and Information Security Guide

Service Desk, Accounts, Devices, Network and Security Practices

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Note: The Sample Company Data is a fictional company. This document is sample data created for building and testing a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) assistant. It is a companion to the Employee Handbook v4.0.

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1. About IT Support

This guide explains how IT services work at The Sample Company Data, how to get help, and what every employee must do to keep company information safe. It applies to all employees, contractors and interns who use company systems. Where this guide and the Employee Handbook differ, the more recent document takes priority and IT should be informed so that the difference can be corrected.

1.1 How to Contact IT

Channel	Details	Best For
HelpDesk portal	helpdesk.samplecompany.example	All non-urgent requests; creates a trackable ticket
Email	it-support@samplecompany.example	Requests when the portal is not reachable
Phone hotline	Extension 4000	Urgent issues that stop you from working
Walk-in desk	Floor 4, Bengaluru; Floor 2, Pune; Floor 11, Gurugram	Hardware swaps and in-person help
Security reports	security@samplecompany.example	Phishing, malware and suspected data leaks

1.2 Support Hours

IT support is available Monday to Friday, 8:00 AM to 8:00 PM, at all offices. Outside these hours, only SEV-1 incidents are handled, through the on-call engineer who is reachable via extension 4000. Planned maintenance is performed on Saturdays between 10:00 PM and 2:00 AM and is announced on SampleChat at least 3 days earlier.

1.3 Who Is Responsible for What

Team	Responsibility
Service Desk	First-line support, ticket logging, password resets, basic troubleshooting
Infrastructure	Servers, network, Wi-Fi, VPN gateway, backup systems
End-User Computing	Laptops, peripherals, mobile devices, software deployment
Information Security	Security monitoring, access reviews, incident response, awareness training
Identity and Access	Account creation, role-based access, multi-factor authentication

2. New Joiner IT Setup

IT prepares your equipment and accounts before your joining date, based on the information provided by HR. Your accounts are ready by 9:30 AM on Day 1.

2.1 What You Receive on Day 1

- A company laptop with the standard software image, a charger and a laptop bag.
- An email account, a SampleChat account and access to SampleDocs.
- Accounts on PeopleHub, ExpenseDesk and HelpDesk.
- A temporary password, which you must change at first login.
- A short orientation session of 30 minutes with the Service Desk.

2.2 First-Login Steps

1. Log in with your username and the temporary password sent to your personal email and mobile number.
2. Create a new password of at least 12 characters with uppercase, lowercase, a number and a symbol.
3. Install the authenticator app on your phone and scan the QR code to enrol in multi-factor authentication (MFA).
4. Save your 10 backup codes in a safe place that is not on your laptop.
5. Install SampleConnect VPN from the Software Centre and test the connection.
6. Complete the Information Security Awareness course on Learn@Sample within 7 days.

2.3 Extra Access for Specific Roles

Engineers receive access to CodeVault, BuildFlow and TrackIt after their manager approves the request on the HelpDesk. Finance employees receive access to ERP systems after approval from the Finance Head and a Restricted-data confirmation by Information Security. Standard access requests are completed within 2 working days.

3. Service Desk and Service Levels

Every request is logged as a ticket and assigned a priority. The priority decides how fast IT must respond. Please select the correct priority when you raise a ticket. Repeated misuse of P1 for non-critical issues may result in the ticket being downgraded.

3.1 Priority Levels and SLAs

Priority	Example	First Response	Resolution Target
P1 - Critical	Company-wide outage, VPN down for everyone	15 minutes	4 hours
P2 - High	Laptop will not boot, email not working	1 hour	8 hours

Priority	Example	First Response	Resolution Target
P3 - Medium	Software installation, slow laptop	4 hours	3 working days
P4 - Low	Peripheral request, general query	1 working day	5 working days

SLA time is counted only within support hours. For example, a P2 ticket raised at 7:30 PM has its response clock paused until 8:00 AM the next working day unless it is a SEV-1 incident.

3.2 Ticket Lifecycle

1. **New:** the ticket is logged and you receive an acknowledgement email.
2. **Assigned:** an engineer takes ownership.
3. **In Progress:** the engineer is working on the issue; you may be asked for more details.
4. **Resolved:** the engineer has applied a fix and asks you to confirm.
5. **Closed:** the ticket closes automatically after 3 working days if you do not respond, or immediately when you confirm.

3.3 Escalation Matrix

If the SLA is missed by	Escalate To	How
30 minutes	Service Desk Shift Lead	Call extension 4000
4 hours	IT Operations Manager	Reply to the ticket with the word ESCALATE
1 working day	Head of IT	Email it-head@samplecompany.example

4. Accounts, Passwords and Multi-Factor Authentication

4.1 Password Rules

- Passwords must be at least 12 characters long and include uppercase, lowercase, a number and a symbol.
- Passwords expire every 90 days, and the last 5 passwords cannot be reused.
- Passwords must not contain your name, username, employee ID or the company name.
- Never share your password with anyone, including IT staff. IT will never ask for it.
- Use a different password for personal accounts than for company accounts.
- A password manager approved by the company is available in the Software Centre.

4.2 Account Lockout

After 5 failed login attempts the account is locked for 30 minutes. You can wait for the lock to expire or call extension 4000 to have the Service Desk unlock it after verifying your identity with your employee ID and your manager's name.

4.3 Resetting a Forgotten Password

1. Open reset.samplecompany.example from any device.
2. Enter your employee ID or work email address.
3. Approve the request in your authenticator app, or enter the one-time code sent to your registered mobile number.
4. Choose a new password that follows the rules above.
5. Log out and log in again on all devices.

4.4 Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

MFA is mandatory for email, VPN and all cloud tools. The preferred method is the authenticator app. A hardware security key is available on request for employees who handle Restricted data. SMS codes are allowed only as a backup method. If you lose your phone, call extension 4000 with your employee ID; after identity verification the Identity team resets MFA, which takes about 30 minutes. Backup codes can also be used once each.

4.5 Shared and Service Accounts

Shared accounts are not allowed except for approved service accounts used by applications. Every service account must have a named owner, a documented purpose and a password rotated every 180 days. Service account owners must confirm each account's need during the quarterly access review.

5. Laptops and Hardware

5.1 Standard Laptop Models

Role	Standard Device	Memory and Storage
Business, HR, Finance, Operations	14-inch business laptop	16 GB RAM, 512 GB SSD
Software Engineers	15-inch performance laptop	32 GB RAM, 1 TB SSD
Designers and Data Teams	16-inch workstation laptop	32 GB RAM, 1 TB SSD, dedicated graphics
Executives (L6 and above)	14-inch premium ultrabook	16 GB RAM, 1 TB SSD

Laptops are refreshed every 3 years. Employees may request an early replacement only if the device is beyond economical repair, as decided by End-User Computing. Peripherals such as a keyboard, mouse and headset are provided on request and replaced when faulty.

5.2 Hardware Problems

Raise a ticket on the HelpDesk and describe the fault. For faults that cannot be fixed remotely, visit the walk-in desk. A loaner laptop is provided for repairs that take more than 1 working day. Most repairs are completed within 3 working days; battery and keyboard replacements are usually done the same day.

5.3 Lost or Stolen Devices

1. Report it to IT within 2 hours, by calling extension 4000 or emailing it-support@samplecompany.example.
2. Inform the security desk, and file a police report if the device was stolen outside the office.
3. IT will remotely lock and wipe the device and disable your accounts until you re-enrol.
4. A replacement is issued within 2 working days after the report.
5. If the loss was due to negligence, the cost may be recovered from the employee, based on the device's remaining value.

5.4 Care of Company Devices

- Do not leave a laptop in a car, or unattended in public places.
- Do not attempt to open or repair the device yourself.
- Do not install personal software or games.
- Keep food and drinks away from the laptop.
- Restart the laptop at least once a week so that security updates can be applied.

5.5 Returning a Device

When you leave the company, return your laptop, charger, badge and any other assets to End-User Computing on your last working day. The device is checked, and your No Dues Certificate from IT is issued only after the return is confirmed. A missing device is charged at its depreciated value, which is deducted from the full and final settlement.

6. Network, Wi-Fi and VPN

6.1 Wi-Fi Networks in the Office

Network Name	Who Can Use It	How to Connect
Sample-Corp	Employees on company laptops	Automatic after first login with your company account
Sample-Mobile	Enrolled personal phones (MDM)	Use the certificate pushed by MDM
Sample-Guest	Visitors	Register on the visitor portal; password valid for 1 day

Guest Wi-Fi has no access to internal systems. Employees must not connect personal laptops to Sample-Corp.

6.2 Installing SampleConnect VPN

1. Open the Software Centre on your laptop.
2. Search for SampleConnect and click Install.
3. Open the client and enter vpn.samplecompany.example as the gateway.
4. Log in with your company account and approve the MFA prompt.

5 When connected, the icon turns green. The VPN disconnects automatically after 12 hours.

6.3 When to Use the VPN

A VPN connection is required whenever you work outside the office, including at home, in a co-working space, a hotel or an airport. It must also be on whenever you use public Wi-Fi. The VPN is not required while connected to Sample-Corp inside an office.

6.4 VPN Troubleshooting

Error / Symptom	Likely Cause	What to Do
Error 809	Router or firewall blocks UDP ports 500 and 4500	Check that your home router allows these ports, or use a mobile hotspot to test. If it still fails, raise a P2 ticket.
Error 691	Wrong username or password	Reset your password at reset.samplecompany.example and try again.
Error 800	Gateway cannot be reached	Check your internet connection and confirm the gateway name is vpn.samplecompany.example.
MFA prompt does not arrive	Phone offline or app out of sync	Open the authenticator app and enter the code manually, or use a backup code.
Connected but internal sites do not open	DNS issue after connection	Disconnect and reconnect; restart the laptop; if the problem continues, raise a P3 ticket.
Very slow speed	Congested home network	Move closer to the router, close video streaming and try a wired connection.

7. Email and Collaboration Tools

7.1 Mailbox and Storage Limits

Service	Limit
Mailbox size	50 GB per employee
Maximum attachment size	25 MB (use a SampleDocs link for larger files)
SampleDocs personal storage	200 GB per employee
SampleDocs team shared storage	1 TB per team
Email retention	3 years, then automatically archived
Deleted files in SampleDocs	Recoverable from the recycle bin for 30 days

7.2 Email Good Practice

- Use clear subject lines and keep messages short.
- Avoid using Reply All unless everyone needs the answer.
- Check the recipient's address before sending any Confidential file.

- Encrypt emails containing Confidential data sent outside the company using the Encrypt button.
- Do not auto-forward company email to personal addresses.

7.3 SampleChat and SampleMeet

SampleChat is the main tool for quick communication. Channels are public by default; private channels can be created for sensitive topics. Messages in SampleChat are retained for 1 year. SampleMeet supports meetings of up to 300 participants, and recordings are stored for 90 days. Do not record meetings without telling the participants. Confidential or Restricted topics should not be discussed in meetings with external guests present unless approved.

7.4 Sharing Files Safely

Share documents using SampleDocs links and set the access to specific people instead of anyone with the link. For external sharing of Confidential files, set an expiry of no more than 30 days and require sign-in. Never use personal email, personal cloud drives or messaging apps to send company files.

8. Software Management

The Software Centre contains approved applications that can be installed with one click. Software in the Software Centre has been checked for licensing and security.

8.1 Requesting New Software

1. Check the Software Centre; the tool may already be available.
2. Raise a Software Request ticket on the HelpDesk with the name, purpose, cost and the number of users.
3. Your manager approves the business need.
4. Information Security reviews the tool within 5 working days.
5. End-User Computing deploys it, or Procurement arranges the licence if payment is needed.

8.2 Licence Compliance

Use only software that the company has licensed. Free tools for personal use may not be legally used for business. Audits are carried out every year, and unlicensed software found on a device is removed. Employees who knowingly install pirated software may face disciplinary action under the Employee Handbook.

8.3 Prohibited Software

- Peer-to-peer file sharing and torrent applications.
- Remote access tools not provided by IT, such as personal screen-sharing software.
- Cryptocurrency mining software.
- Hacking, password-cracking or network scanning tools, unless used by the Information Security team.
- Browser extensions that read page content, unless approved by Information Security.

8.4 Updates and Patching

Security updates are pushed to laptops automatically. Critical updates must be installed within 7 days, and other updates within 30 days. If you see a restart notification, save your work and restart as soon as possible; after 3 postponements the laptop restarts automatically outside core hours.

9. Information Security Essentials

9.1 Recognising Phishing

Phishing emails try to trick you into clicking a link, opening an attachment or sharing your credentials. Warning signs include a sense of urgency, requests for passwords or payment changes, unexpected attachments, mismatched sender addresses and poor spelling. When in doubt, do not click.

9.2 How to Report a Suspicious Email

1. Do not click any link or open any attachment.
2. Click the Report Phishing button in your email client, or forward the email as an attachment to security@samplecompany.example.
3. If you already clicked a link or entered your password, call extension 4000 immediately and change your password.
4. Delete the email after reporting.

Employees receive a simulated phishing test every quarter. Employees who click on the simulation are automatically enrolled in a 15-minute refresher course.

9.3 Information Classification Summary

Level	Examples	Key Rule
Public	Website content, press releases	No restriction
Internal	Org charts, announcements	Do not share outside the company
Confidential	Contracts, pricing, source code, salary data	Need-to-know basis; encrypt when emailing externally
Restricted	Customer personal data, passwords, unreleased financial reports	Only through approved systems; never on personal devices

9.4 USB Drives and Removable Media

Personal USB storage devices are blocked on company laptops. If you need to transfer files, use SampleDocs. Company-issued encrypted USB drives are available only with approval from Information Security, and must be returned or destroyed securely when no longer needed. Never plug in a USB device found in a public place.

9.5 Physical Security

- Wear your badge visibly and do not allow tailgating through doors.
- Lock your screen using Windows+L or Control+Command+Q when you leave your desk.

- Shred printed Confidential documents; do not use regular bins.
- Report any unescorted visitor to the security desk at extension 5000.

9.6 Use of AI Tools

SampleAssist is the approved internal AI assistant. Never enter Confidential or Restricted information, customer data or source code into public AI tools. AI-generated output must be checked by a human before it is used in customer deliverables.

10. Security Incidents and Data Breaches

A security incident is any event that may harm the confidentiality, integrity or availability of company information. Examples are a lost laptop, a compromised account, malware, an email sent to the wrong person with Confidential data, and unauthorised access to a system.

10.1 What You Must Do

1. Stop and do not try to fix it yourself or delete evidence.
2. Report it immediately to security@samplecompany.example and call extension 4000. Any suspected breach of personal data must be reported within 2 hours of discovery.
3. Write down what happened, when, and which systems or data were involved.
4. Follow the instructions of the Incident Manager and keep the matter confidential.

10.2 Severity Levels

Severity	Description	Who Leads	Update Frequency
SEV-1	Customer-facing outage, confirmed data breach, or safety threat	Chief Information Security Officer and CTO	Every 30 minutes
SEV-2	Major degradation or compromise of an entire office or large team	Incident Manager	Every 1 hour
SEV-3	Limited impact on one team or a non-critical system	Information Security analyst	Every 4 hours

10.3 After the Incident

Within 5 working days of a SEV-1 or SEV-2 incident being resolved, the Information Security team prepares a post-incident review that records the cause, the impact, what worked, and actions to prevent a repeat. Employees involved in the incident are not blamed for honest mistakes reported quickly. Failure to report an incident, or hiding it, may lead to disciplinary action.

10.4 Regulatory Notification

Where required by law, the Data Protection Officer notifies the Data Protection Board of India and the affected individuals. Customers are notified as required by their contract, which is normally within 72 hours of confirmation of a breach affecting their data.

11. Access Management

11.1 Principles

- **Least privilege:** you get only the access needed for your role.
- **Need to know:** access to Confidential and Restricted data requires business justification.
- **Separation of duties:** the same person cannot both request and approve high-risk access.
- **Time-bound access:** privileged access is granted for a limited period, usually 8 hours.

11.2 Joiner, Mover and Leaver Process

Event	Action	Timeline
Joiner	Accounts created from HR data; standard access given	Ready by 9:30 AM on Day 1
Mover (transfer or promotion)	Old role access removed and new role access requested	Within 5 working days of the effective date
Leaver	All accounts disabled and devices collected	At the end of the last working day
Leaver in a risk case	Access removed immediately on HR instruction	Immediate

11.3 Quarterly Access Reviews

Each quarter, managers receive a list of the access held by their team members and must confirm or remove it within 10 working days. Access that is not confirmed is removed automatically. Reviews for systems with Restricted data are also checked by Information Security.

11.4 Privileged Access

Administrators use separate admin accounts, which are never used for email or web browsing. Privileged sessions are recorded and reviewed monthly. Access to production systems requires approval from the system owner and an active ticket reference.

12. Mobile Devices and Personal Phones

Employees may use a personal phone for company email and SampleChat after enrolling in Mobile Device Management (MDM). Enrolment creates a separate work area on the phone.

12.1 Enrolling a Phone

1. Install the company portal app from the app store.
2. Log in with your company account and accept the policy.
3. Set a screen lock with a PIN of at least 6 digits or biometrics.
4. Wait for the work area to be created, which takes about 10 minutes.

12.2 What the Company Can and Cannot See

The company CAN	The company CANNOT
Remove company email and data from the phone	See your personal photos, messages or calls
Require a screen lock and encryption	Track your location
Check the operating system version	See your browsing history or personal apps

If you lose your phone or leave the company, the company data is removed. Personal data is not touched. Phones that are rooted or jailbroken cannot be enrolled. Company-owned phones are issued only to employees whose role needs it, for example on-call engineers and sales leaders.

13. Backup and Data Recovery

13.1 What Is Backed Up

Data	Backup Frequency	Retention
SampleDocs files	Continuous version history	30 days of versions; deleted files for 30 days
Email	Daily	3 years
Production databases	Every 6 hours	35 days
Source code in CodeVault	Continuous replication to a second region	Indefinite
Laptop local files	Not backed up	Save work in SampleDocs

Files saved only on the laptop's local drive are not backed up. If the laptop fails, local files may be lost. Save all work in SampleDocs.

13.2 Restoring Files

To recover a deleted file, open the recycle bin in SampleDocs and select Restore. To restore an earlier version of a file, right-click the file and choose Version History. For items older than 30 days, or mailbox items, raise a P3 ticket with the file name and approximate date.

14. Troubleshooting Quick Guide

Try these steps before raising a ticket. Many common problems can be solved in a few minutes.

Problem	Try This First	If It Persists
Laptop is slow	Close unused apps; restart the laptop; check free disk space (keep at least 15% free)	Raise a P3 ticket
Cannot connect to Wi-Fi	Turn Wi-Fi off and on; forget and rejoin Sample-Corp	Visit the walk-in desk
No sound in meetings	Check the selected speaker and microphone in SampleMeet settings	Raise a P4 ticket
Email not syncing	Check internet and VPN; restart the email app	Raise a P2 ticket

Problem	Try This First	If It Persists
Cannot open a shared file	Ask the owner to share it with your email address	Raise a P4 ticket
Screen is frozen	Hold the power button for 10 seconds and restart	Raise a P2 ticket if it repeats
Printer does not print	Check you are logged in and tap your badge at the printer	Raise a P4 ticket
Locked out of MFA	Use a backup code	Call extension 4000
Software will not install	Restart and try again from the Software Centre	Raise a P3 ticket

15. IT Frequently Asked Questions

What are the IT support hours?

Monday to Friday, 8:00 AM to 8:00 PM. Only SEV-1 incidents are handled outside these hours.

How fast will IT respond to my laptop that will not start?

That is a P2 ticket, with a first response within 1 hour and a resolution target of 8 hours.

How long is the lockout after wrong password attempts?

The account is locked for 30 minutes after 5 failed attempts. Call extension 4000 to unlock it sooner.

How often must I change my password?

Every 90 days. You cannot reuse your last 5 passwords.

What is the minimum password length?

12 characters, with uppercase, lowercase, a number and a symbol.

I lost my phone with the authenticator app. What do I do?

Call extension 4000 with your employee ID. After verification, the Identity team resets your MFA in about 30 minutes. You can also use a backup code.

My laptop was stolen. How fast must I report it?

Within 2 hours. IT will remotely lock and wipe it, and a replacement is issued within 2 working days.

How big a file can I send by email?

Up to 25 MB. For larger files, share a SampleDocs link.

Can I recover a file I deleted by mistake?

Yes. Files in SampleDocs can be restored from the recycle bin for 30 days.

The VPN shows error 809. What does it mean?

Usually your router or firewall blocks UDP ports 500 and 4500. Check your router settings or test with a mobile hotspot. If it still fails, raise a P2 ticket.

How long does it take to approve new software?

Information Security reviews Software Requests within 5 working days.

Can I plug in my personal USB drive?

No. Personal USB storage is blocked. Use SampleDocs to transfer files.

How soon must I report a data breach?

Immediately, and in any case within 2 hours of discovery, to security@samplecompany.example and extension 4000.

How often are laptops replaced?

Every 3 years.

Can I use ChatGPT for work documents?

Do not enter Confidential or Restricted information, customer data or source code into public AI tools. Use SampleAssist, the approved internal assistant.

How long are SampleChat messages kept?

1 year. Meeting recordings in SampleMeet are kept for 90 days.

16. Glossary and Key Contacts

Term	Meaning
CISO	Chief Information Security Officer
DNS	Domain Name System; translates website names into addresses
MDM	Mobile Device Management: software that secures phones used for work
MFA	Multi-Factor Authentication: an extra verification step in addition to the password
Phishing	A fraudulent message designed to steal credentials or money
SEV	Severity level of an incident
SLA	Service Level Agreement: response and resolution time targets
VPN	Virtual Private Network: a secure connection to company systems

Key Contacts

Topic	Contact
General IT support	it-support@samplecompany.example, extension 4000
Security incidents and phishing	security@samplecompany.example
Data protection officer	dpo@samplecompany.example
Head of IT escalation	it-head@samplecompany.example
Security desk (physical)	Extension 5000
Password reset portal	reset.samplecompany.example
VPN gateway	vpn.samplecompany.example

End of document. This guide is a fictional sample created for building and testing a RAG assistant.